

Different sexual identities

A person's sexual identity describes the gender(s) of the people who they want to be romantic or sexual with. Sexual identity is just one part of who a person is, and they should not be defined by it.

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Useful terms

There are many different words that are used when people talk about sexual identity. If a person doesn't see themselves represented in the list below, it is because of the limitations of such definitions, not because that teen cannot be who they are.

GOOD TO KNOW

LGBTQ+

LGBTQ is a collective term for sexual identities that aren't straight. A + sign is sometimes added at the end to indicate the wider spectrum of sexualities not included in the existing letters.

Straight

A person is described as straight, or heterosexual, if they want to be romantic and sexual with people of a different sex.



Gay

This term describes someone who prefers to be romantic and sexual with people of the same sex. They are sometimes referred to as homosexual.



Bisexual

A person who is bisexual, or bi, wants to be romantic and sexual with people of the same sex and of a different sex. They are sometimes called pansexual.



Asexual

An asexual person isn't interested in sexual contact with anyone. They may or may not be interested in romantic connections.



Aromantic

Someone who is aromantic isn't interested in romantic connections with anyone. They may or may not be interested in sexual contact.



Queer

This term is used to describe a wide range of sexual identities other than straight.

